



# Irina Bazhenova

Communications designer

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Portfolio

Website

HSE

## Education

### Higher School of Economics Art and Design School

**Bachelor of Design** GPA 8.5/10

Moscow  
2023 — 2027

**Tracks:** Communication Design (2025 — 2027) / Design and Programming (2023 — 2025)

**Key focus:** Digital product, brand identity systems, 3D building, subject design and motion.

### Art School

**Diploma in Applied Arts** GPA 5/5

Barnaul  
2013 — 2021

**Tracks:** Applied arts / Painting / Book / Art history / Plein air

**Key focus:** Academic drawing, color theory, working with the material and form, classical history.

## Work experience

### Sminex

**Communication & Graphic Designer**

Moscow  
August 2025 — March 2026

- Designed promotional layouts and digital assets for corporate SMM and brand events.
- Developed environmental graphic design (EGD) and spatial navigation guides for residential properties.
- Created operational user guides and interactive children's print collaterals across complexes.

### ALL AGES

**Graphic & SMM Designer**

Moscow  
January 2025 — August 2025

- Developed a full brand identity and authored an end-to-end brandbook.
- Produced 1,500+ static, 3D and motion assets across 5 client brands.

### Higher School of Economics Art and Design School

**Assistant designer**

Moscow  
September 2025 — July 2026

- Facilitated interactive workshops and masterclasses for 30 students organizing course workflows.
- Prepared lecture presentation and interactive assets for 5 sessions.
- Guided 5 student teams to project defenses and organized the poster exhibition.

### Freelance initiatives

**Multidisciplinary Designer**

Moscow  
2022 — 2026

**UX/UI:** deployed functional commercial websites, combining website builders with custom code.

**Branding:** executed brand identity systems for cultural and art festivals.

**Graphic design:** produced 18 promotional posters for the design of festivals, theatrical productions and musical groups.

**Subject design:** developed 2 furniture pieces from technical drawings to physical concepts.

## Achievements

**1st Place | Design Workshop 2025 |** Packaging for the theater "Cashmere".

Acted as Lead Communication Designer in the team, developed the core packaging concept and visual identity for a product.

**1st Place | "Play Moscow" Creative Laboratory 2026 |** Design for the objects of the gift fund "Play Moscow".

Led the team, managed workflows. Spearheaded the design of branded promo items and packaging from concept to final mockups.

**1st Place | FilmART Connect. Shared Frames: Hungarian Watchlist 2026 |** Posters for the Hungarian film "White Palms".

Designing a conceptual poster dedicated for the Hungarian film "White Palms".

**Finalist | Visual identity for the "DAFES Typography" festival 2026 |** Visual identity for the "DAFES Typography" 2027

Developed a conceptual identity project featured at an on-site exhibition in Moscow.

**Finalist | World graphic design biennale Golden Bee 17 2026 |** Graphic Kandinsky's poster

Designing a conceptual poster dedicated to Kandinsky's 160th anniversary.

## Hard skills

- Graphics/Motion:** Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects, Premiere Pro, InDesign
- UX/UI:** Figma, Tilda, Framer, Readymag
- 3D:** Blender
- AI:** Midjourney, Nano Banana, Kling, Grok, Chat GPT, Leonardo
- Progaming:** HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Python
- Languages:** English (C1-Advanced), Russian (Native)

## Soft skills & Interests

- Strengths:** high emotional intelligence, data-driven critical thinking, attention to detail, proactive team communication and resilience under pressure
- Personal hobby:** snowboarding, mountain hiking, horseback riding, oil painting, chess, driving